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COLLECTION

SELLERS

Managing Multiple Offers

For sellers —
turn competition
into results.

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Important notice

This guide is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It presents general information about real estate in Quebec and does not constitute personalized real estate, legal, tax or financial advice. Every real estate situation is different, and you should consult the appropriate professionals before making a decision about a transaction.

Handling Multiple Offers as a Seller

Turn competition into a better outcome, without losing control

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Receiving several offers is good news... which can quickly become stressful. Managed well, the multiple offer situation maximizes your price and terms; poorly managed, it scares away buyers or creates disputes.

This guide explains how a situation of multiple offers is created, how to compare them beyond the price, and how to decide methodically and fairly.

Each chapter ends with a lined “My Notes” page.

Multiple offers excite as much as they destabilize. Well managed, they maximize the seller's results; poorly managed, they lead to errors. This guide explains how they come about, how to compare offers beyond price, the rules to follow and how to decide methodically - on the seller AND buyer side.

CHAPTER

How are multiple offers born?

> *Understand what creates competition.*

Multiple offers almost always result from two ingredients: a good (attractive) starting price and a well-prepared and well-publicized property. The rarity and momentum of the launch do the rest.

This is therefore not the result of chance: it is the result of a well-executed pricing and marketing strategy (see the dedicated guides).

Multiple offers are almost always born from two ingredients: a desirable property and a well-calibrated price that creates emulation. This is not a stroke of luck but the result of a good pricing and marketing strategy.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *A fair, even slightly inviting, starting price often creates more value than an inflated price: it attracts several buyers and lets competition drive up offers.*

CHAPTER

Compare offers beyond price

> *Evaluate each offer as a whole.*

- Price, of course - but not only that.
- Conditions: inspection, financing, document review (fewer conditions = more certainty).
- Strength of buyer financing (strong vs uncertain pre-approval).
- Possession dates that suit you.
- Deposit and general seriousness of the offer.

The highest offer is not always the best: a slightly lower but almost certain offer may be worth more than a high and fragile offer.

Compare each offer as a whole, not just the price: conditions (inspection, financing), dates, deposit, strength of the buyer (pre-approval). A slightly lower but unconditional and well-financed offer may be the safest.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Look at the certainty as much as the amount. A high offer conditional on the sale of the buyer's home may fall through; a solid, well-financed offer goes to the notary.*

CHAPTER

The rules of the game: fairness and transparency

> *Manage the process correctly and without missteps.*

The management of multiple offers is governed by rules of transparency and fairness towards all buyers. Your broker ensures compliance with the process (fair treatment, appropriate communication) to avoid any dispute.

- You can accept an offer, refuse it, or make a counter-offer.
- The process must remain fair to all buyers.
- We avoid any maneuver that could be perceived as misleading.

The management of multiple offers is governed by rules of fairness and transparency: all buyers must be treated correctly and informed of the process. A misstep can invalidate a transaction or expose you to a complaint - hence the interest of a professional executive.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Let your broker manage the process according to the rules. Fair and transparent management protects your sale against disputes - and preserves your reputation.*

CHAPTER

Decide without getting carried away

> *Choose the best offer methodically.*

The euphoria of multiple offers can lead to hasty decisions. Set your priorities in advance (price, dates, certainty), compare coldly, and choose the offer that best serves YOUR goal - not just the biggest number.

Remember: accepting an offer is a commitment. Choose the one that has the best chance of making it to signing.

Euphoria pushes hasty decisions. Set your criteria in advance (price, conditions, acceptable dates), evaluate coldly, and remember that the best offer is the one that makes it to the notary - not just the highest on paper.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Decide according to your priorities established cold, not in the heat of the auction. The best offer is the one that achieves your objective AND is most likely to succeed.*

CHAPTER

Buyer's side: stand out from the crowd without overpaying

> *Make a winning and reasonable offer.*

Faced with multiple offers, the buyer can stand out without necessarily offering the largest amount:

- Arrive **pre-approved** and ready to act.
- Propose **conditions and deadlines** attractive for the seller (flexible dates).
- Offer a **thoughtful price**, based on comparables, not on emotion.
- Set yourself a **limit** closes in advance.

A solid, serious offer is often as reassuring as an extra dollar - and protects you from the regret of having overpaid.

On the buyer's side, you can stand out without blindly outbidding: arrive pre-approved, offer flexible dates, make a clean offer and set your ceiling in advance. A solid offer often provides as much reassurance as an extra dollar - and protects you from the regret of overpaying.

> EMILIE'S ADVICE
>
> *Set your maximum price BEFORE entering into a bidding war, and stick to it. Losing a property hurts for a week; overpaying by $30,000 hurts for years. Discipline pays.*

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

> *Your next steps, concretely.*

This week

1. Define my priorities (price, dates, certainty) before putting it on sale.
2. Align prices and marketing to encourage competition.

Within 30 days

1. Compare the offers received on all criteria.
2. Let my broker manage a fair process.

Then

1. Choose the offer with the best price/certainty balance.

To manage well

1. Establish in advance my criteria (price, conditions, dates) and the process.
2. Evaluate each offer as a whole, not just the amount.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Multiple offers: multiple buyers submit at the same time.
- Conditions: inspection, financing, examination of documents modulating certainty.
- Certainty of an offer: probability that it will be signed.
- Counter-proposal: response from the seller modifying the terms.
- Fairness of the process: transparent treatment of all buyers.

- Multiple offers: several offers received at the same time on a property.
- Conditional offer: offer subject to inspection, financing, etc.
- Solidity of the buyer: pre-approval and real capacity to close.
- Fairness and transparency: rules governing the processing of offers.
- Ceiling: maximum amount set in advance by the buyer.

GO FURTHER

Quiz - test yourself

1. Multiple offers mainly result:

A) Chance

B) Good pricing and good marketing

C) An inflated price

D) Lack of preparation

2. An offer is evaluated:

A) On price alone

B) On price, conditions, financing, dates

C) Random

D) On the signature

3. The highest offer is:

A) Always the best

B) Not necessarily, if it is fragile

C) Illegal

D) Without interest

4. The multiple offer process must be:

A) Opaque

B) Fair and transparent

C) Rigged

D) Secrecy

5. Faced with offers, you can:

A) Only accept

B) Accept, refuse or counter-offer

C) Do nothing

D) Cancel the law

6. The euphoria of multiple offers can lead to:

A) Better decisions

B) Hasty decisions

C) Nothing

D) More certainty

7. The best offer is the one which:

A) Has the largest number only

B) Serves your goal AND is most likely to succeed

C) Is the most fragile

D) Comes last

8. A high offer conditional on the sale of the buyer's house:

A) Is the safest

B) Can collapse

C) Is risk-free

D) Is always better

Answers

1. B - It is an executed strategy (chap. 1).

2. B - We look at the whole (chap. 2).

3. B - Certainty also matters (chap. 2).

4. B - Rules govern the processing (chap. 3).

5. B - Three options exist (chap. 3).

6. B - We decide cold (chap. 4).

7. B - Objective + certainty (chap. 4).

8. B - It is more uncertain (chap. 2).

Make informed decisions.
Choose with confidence.
Move forward without regret.

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